

How to configure Centralized Agent Groups in wazuh

In this lesson we will learn how we can make our wazuh SIEM flexible like using the centralized agent configuration method

1- Why is centralized agent configuration important?

Because it offers four major benefits:

1. **Centralized Management:** If you have 100 Windows machines and need to add a new log monitoring rule, updating them manually takes hours. By creating a Windows group and adding all 100 machines to it, a single update automatically applies the rule to every agent.
2. **Consistency:** You can create distinct, dedicated policies for Windows machines and Linux machines to ensure configurations remain uniform across your environment.
3. **Scalability:** In an enterprise environment with hundreds of machines and servers, you can apply new rules across all devices in just a few moments.
4. **Security Compliance:** You can apply tailored monitoring rules for specific operating systems to meet compliance requirements. For example, you can enable registry monitoring and PowerShell logging for the Windows group, while enabling sudo command monitoring and file integrity checks for the Linux group.



2- Managing Agent Groups in Wazuh

1. Navigate to the Wazuh dashboard, click the **three horizontal lines (menu)** in the top-left corner, go to **Agent management**, and select **Groups**.
2. Click **Add new group** to create distinct categories for your endpoints based on their operating system or function (e.g., separate groups for Windows hosts and Linux servers).
3. Open a specific group (such as your Windows group), go to **Manage agents**, select the relevant agents you want to include, and click **Apply changes** to assign them to the group.

3- Configuring Centralized Agent Settings (agent.conf)

Wazuh allows you to manage agent configurations centrally from the manager using the agent.conf file, pushing updates out to all members of a specific group.

Now let's apply rule or configuration to each group

1. For windows do:

Go to C:\ drive → C:\Program Files (x86)\ossec-agent\shared → open agent.conf

Go back to wazuh SIEM or manager and do:

In the Wazuh dashboard, navigate to **Agent management > Groups**, and click on your Windows group.

Select the **Configuration** (or **File**) tab and open agent.conf.

Add the following XML configuration block to collect core Windows Event Logs (Security, System, and Application) from all agents in this group

```
<agent_config>
  <!-- Collect Windows Security Event Logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>eventchannel</log_format>
    <location>Security</location>
  </localfile>

  <!-- Collect Windows System Event Logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>eventchannel</log_format>
    <location>System</location>
  </localfile>

  <!-- Collect Windows Application Event Logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>eventchannel</log_format>
    <location>Application</location>
  </localfile>
</agent_config>
```

And save

For Linux do:

Sudo /var/ossec/etc/shared and open agent.conf (all change will happen here)

Go back to wazuh SIEM or manager and do:

In the Wazuh dashboard, navigate to your Linux group under **Agent management > Groups**.

Open the **Configuration** tab and select agent.conf.

Add the following XML configuration block to collect standard Linux system, authentication, and kernel logs:

```
<agent_config>
  <!-- Collect system logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>syslog</log_format>
    <location>/var/log/syslog</location>
  </localfile>

  <!-- Collect authentication logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>syslog</log_format>
    <location>/var/log/auth.log</location>
  </localfile>

  <!-- Collect kernel logs -->
  <localfile>
    <log_format>syslog</log_format>
    <location>/var/log/kern.log</location>
  </localfile>
</agent_config>
```

And save

Restart the Wazuh Manager

Apply all centralized configuration updates by restarting the Wazuh manager service on your server:

Bash

```
sudo systemctl restart wazuh-manager
```

WAZUH SIEM | XDR

How to Configure Centralized Agent Groups in Wazuh

Step-by-Step Guide to Manage and Configure Windows and Linux Agents

Centralize Simplify Scale Stay Compliant Improve Security

One Console Full Visibility

1 Why Centralized Agent Configuration?

Centralized agent configuration makes your Wazuh SIEM flexible, efficient, and secure. It offers four major benefits:

1. Centralized Management

Update all agents at once. Example: Add a new rule to 100 Windows machines in minutes.

2. Consistency

Create dedicated policies for Windows and Linux machines to keep configurations uniform.

3. Scalability

Apply new rules across hundreds of devices in just a few moments.

4. Security Compliance

Apply tailored monitoring rules (e.g., registry & PowerShell for Windows, sudo & FIM for Linux) to meet compliance requirements.

2 Access Agent Groups in Wazuh

- 1 Login to your Wazuh dashboard (<https://<your-wazuh-ip>>).
- 2 Click the menu (☰) on the top-left.
- 3 Go to Agent management → Groups.



3 Create a New Group

- 1 Click **Add new group**.
- 2 Enter a group name (e.g., Windows, Linux).
- 3 Click **Save**.



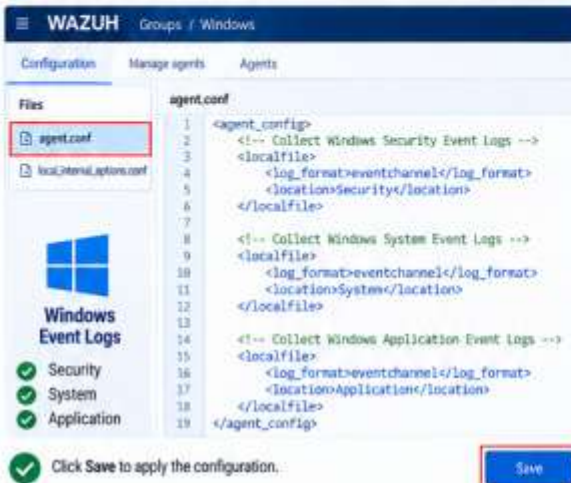
4 Add Agents to a Group

- 1 Open the group (e.g., Windows).
- 2 Click **Manage agents**.
- 3 Select the agents you want to add (check the boxes).
- 4 Click **Apply changes**.



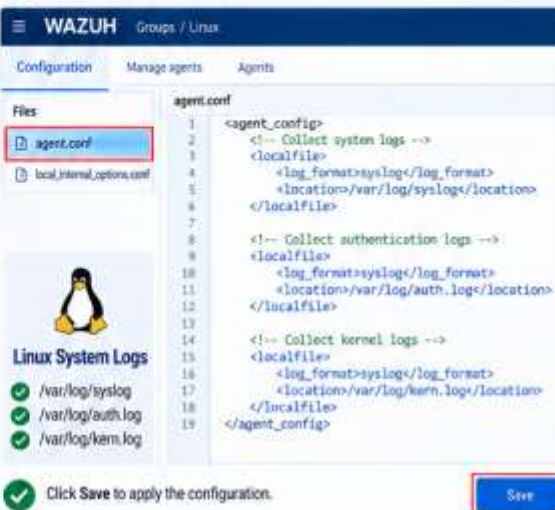
5 Configure Windows Group (agent.conf)

- 1 On the Wazuh dashboard, open your Windows group.
- 2 Go to the **Configuration** tab and open **agent.conf**.
- 3 Add the following XML configuration to collect Windows Event Logs.



6 Configure Linux Group (agent.conf)

- 1 Open your Linux group → **Configuration** → **agent.conf**.
- 2 Add the following XML configuration to collect Linux logs.



7 Restart the Wazuh Manager

- 1 On your Wazuh server, run the following command:

```
sudo systemctl restart wazuh-manager
```

- 2 Verify the service is running:

```
sudo systemctl status wazuh-manager
```

wazuh-manager.service - Wazuh manager
Active: active (running)

8 Verify Logs & Data Collection

- 1 Check agent status in the dashboard.
- 2 Go to **Security events** to see incoming logs from your Windows and Linux groups.



9 Next Steps

- ✓ Create additional groups (e.g., Web Servers, Database, etc.).
- ✓ Add more monitoring rules.
- ✓ Configure active response if needed.
- ✓ Monitor logs and create custom alerts.
- ✓ Ensure compliance reporting.
- ✓ Scale to hundreds of agents.

"Centralized management.
Stronger security. A safer tomorrow."



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Learn • Practice • Share • Grow

"Knowledge
Builds a Safer
Tomorrow"